NATIONAL ASSEMBLY 7TH PARLIAMENT

PARLIAMENTARY STANDING COMMITTEE ON ECONOMICS AND PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

REPORT ON THE PETITION BY LISHA EMPOWERMENT AND DEVELOPMENT ORGANISATION TITLED *"NAMIBIA'S NATIONAL ASSEMBLY ADDRESS THE URGENT NEED FOR REVIVING THE MARKET FOR LIVESTOCK IN NAMIBIA'S NORTHERN COMMUNAL AREAS"*

REPORT NO. 11 OF 2025

ACRONYMS AND ABBREVIATIONS

Amcom	:	Amalgamated Commercial Holding Association
BBK	:	"Boere Beperk Korporasie"
CBO's	:	Community Based Organizations
CBPP	:	Contagious Bovine Pleuropneumonia Disease
CBT	;	Commodity-Based Trade
CCTV	:	Close Circuit Television
CENORED	:	Central North Regional Electricity Distributor
CEO	:	Chief Executive Officer
CSO's	:	Civil Society Organizations
DVS	:	Directorate Veterinary Services
EDF	:	European Development Fund
ENOK	:	"Eerste Nasionale Ontwikkelings Korporasie"
EU	:	European Union
FMD	:	Food and Mouth Disease
FY	:	Financial Year
GRN	:	Government of the Republic of Namibia
KCR	:	Kavango Cattle Ranch
KWRC	:	Kavango West Regional Council
LLPBN	:	Livestock and Livestock Products Board of Namibia
LSU	:	Livestock Unit
MAWLR	:	Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform
MEATCO	:	Meat Cooperation of Namibia
MEFT	;	Ministry of Environment, Forestry and Tourism
MW	:	Mangetti West
NAMCOR	:	National Petroleum Corporation of Namibia
NCAs	:	Northern Communal Areas
NDC	:	Namibia Development Corporation
NIDA	:	Namibia Industrial Development Agency
NLSA	:	Namibia Liberation Struggle Association
NNFU	:	Namibia National Farmers Union
NNLVA	:	Namibian National Liberation Veterans
O/M/As	:	Offices, Ministries, Agencies
PPP	:	Public Private Partnership
SGC	:	Super Group of Companies
SVCS	:	South of the Veterinary Cordon Fence
TA	:	Traditional Authority
VCF	:	Veterinary Cordon Fence
Vet	:	Veterinary
ZAMCO	:	Zambezi Meat Cooperation

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Economics and Public Administration received a petition lodged by Lisha Empowerment and Development Organization on 14 November 2022, titled ***"that Namibia's National Assembly address the urgent need for reviving the Market for livestock in Namibia's Northern Communal Areas (NCAs)"*** *The* petition was subsequently referred to the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Economics and Public Administration during November 2022 for further investigation, scrutiny and report back to the National Assembly.

The Committee subsequently held public hearings/public consultations in Windhoek, Khomas region and oversight visits to the Northern Communal Areas in **Kunene Region, Omusati Region, Oshana Region, Ohangwena Region, Zambezi Region, Kavango East Region and Kavango West Region.**

The comprehensive report of the public consultations/ hearings and the oversight visits, provides the findings and observations, which are as follows:

- The Veterinary Cordon Fence Policy needs to be reviewed as it was designed to favour a minority group at the expense of the majority of Namibians.
- The VCF is an age old policy dating back to the German colonial period that separates northern Namibia from central and southern parts of the country with the intention to control infectious disease among livestock.
- The rationale behind the policy has been that it has sustained the Namibian meat industry, particularly the export of such products to the European Union (and other international markets. However, critics have criticized the arrangement as limiting communal farmers' access to lucrative domestic, regional and international markets.
- Namibia has over 2.5 million cattle found in the NCAs while the southern part of the veterinary cordon fence accounts for 1.3 million cattle. The export of NCA cattle to international markets is however, restricted by the VCF, and referred to as the red line.
- Freedom from the FMD cannot be achieved with a porous border line between Namibia and Angola as it is difficult to prevent cross border movements of livestock.
- In light of the above, the Ministry proposed that, the only way to get freedom is to establish a physical border movement in order to curb introduction of FMD, CBPP as well as lung sickness and other animal diseases from the neighbouring countries.
- Poor and/or mismanagement; and inadequate maintenance of important GRN property and infrastructure, such as quarantine farms, camps and facilities, crush pens, auction pens and abattoirs are matters of grave concern to the Committee, having aggravated the situation in the NCAs, thereby leading to serious adverse consequences on livestock market accessibility in the NCAs.

Other weaknesses, challenges are shortcomings captioned in the report are the followings:

- Low profitability due to lack of access to lucrative livestock markets.

- Lack of feedlots and fodder production for animals and support to small scale farmers.
- Unequal Pricing/Equalization Fund
- Limited grazing areas due to drought
- Lack of operational and development budget for quarantine camps and abattoirs
- Lack of training/awareness programmes for farmers in livestock rearing and compliance standards on meat markets
- Infrastructural Challenges/Limitation on production and marketing of meat and meat products
- Delay in payment of farmers
- Overgrazing within the quarantine facilities
- Inadequate Drought Relief Incentives
- Lack of Meat Processing Plants
- Location and limited number of loading points coupled by high transport costs, bad roads and poor network
- Vandalism, stock theft and lack of proper fencing at quarantine and abattoir Facilities
- Staff shortage, poor equipment, and delay of vaccines at Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform (DVS) Regional Offices
- Challenges with regards to management, accountability and employee relations at Mangetti Farm – Kavango Cattle Ranch

1. INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND

Namibia has a thriving/growing livestock sector both from the commercial and small scale farmers and livestock rearing is one of the important livelihood for small scale farmers countrywide. The small scale farmers use livestock for consumption and income generation.

However, the marketing of cattle from the Northern Communal Areas is restricted by the Veterinary Cordon Fence, as livestock producers, north of the VCF are not allowed to freely market their animals to the South of the Veterinary Cordon Fence due to Foot and Mouth Disease and Contagious Bovine Pleuropneumonia restrictions. This setup is viewed as disadvantaging NCA Farmers by being excluded from the lucrative EU market, despite more than 60% of Namibia cattle population being in the Northern Communal Areas.

In light of the above, a petition was lodged by Lisha Empowerment and Development Organization on 14 November 2022, titled ***"that Namibia's National Assembly address the urgent need for reviving the Market for livestock in Namibia's Northern Communal Areas (NCAs)"*** *The* petition was subsequently referred to the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Economics and Public Administration during November 2022 for further investigation, scrutiny and report back to the National Assembly.

The petition among others, seeks to address the following:

(i) The urgent need for reviving the market for livestock in the Northern Communal Areas;

(ii) **Lack of effective Quarantines,** including the quarantine facility at Farm Omutambo Maowe which is in a dilapidated condition and has not been able to provide any quarantine services for the past twelve years;

(iii) **Lack of effective abattoirs** to ensure that animal slaughter and meat value chain processing is continuous and the quality of meat products is compliant with standards demanded by the market, both locally and internationally; and

(iv) **Lack of an effective programme to upgrade quality of procured livestock before slaughter:** apart from making animals disease-free, no efforts are made at facility level to improve the quality of abattoir-bound slaughter livestock, resulting in poor quality of meat products and no sustainable market.

The petitioners further stated as follows:

(v) To date, resident livestock farmers in the NCA are no longer able to sustainably sell their livestock as the stated quarantine facility and abattoirs — under the watch of MAWLR – collapsed simultaneously nearly 12 years ago. The sale of livestock, along with the production of mahangu — including sorghum and other edible crops — ensures food security in the NCA as it sustains the livelihoods and well-being of many thousands of local farm' households which, it goes without saying, that farmers experience very untenable economic and social conditions at present.

(vi) That for nearly 12 years to date, the Omutambo Maowe quarantine facility— which is responsible for servicing the stated regions — has been unable to provide any effective services due to a dilapidated physical infrastructure.

(vii) Of the existing 13 boreholes previously installed at the facility, only one (1) borehole is functioning as of September 2022. By July 2022, the facility was without electrical power. According to DVS employees at the site, the previously installed generator had been broken for the last 8 years — and never repaired since then.

(viii) The livestock holding camps on the 24 000-hectare farm were without complete fences at numerous places, making it impossible to separate animals under quarantine from the rest.

(ix) Apart from making animals disease-free, no efforts are made (at the facility level) to improve the quality of abattoir-bound slaughter livestock. As this situation provides no good business, even Meatco had to abandon Eloolo Abattoir at Oshakati and, thereby, threw local farmers to the wolves as early as 12 years ago.

(x) In November 2018, in an effort to relief the situation and meet the government half-way, the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform turned down an offer from a private company called Super Group of Companies to rent out the Farm for an amount of N$120,000 per annual, subject to extensive renovations it and revive business. MAWLR officials were of the opinion that it is very difficult to rent out Government properties.

(xi) Given that the magnitude of alienation of livestock farmers in the stated regions has reached alarming proportions which cannot be prolonged any further, the petition is intended to have this matter closely investigated, debated, and resolved on the most progressive note by Namibia's National Assembly.

Attached please find a copy of the petition as ***Annexure A.***

2. COMMITTEE MEMBERSHIP

The following Members undertook the oversight visits to Kunene, Omusati, Oshikoto, Oshana and Ohangwena regions (Group 1): Honourables: Natangue Ithete (Chairperson and head of delegation), Gotthard Kasuto, Maria Elago, Yvette Araes and Johanna Kandjimi and Group 2: covered Zambezi, Kavango East and Kavango West regions comprised of Honourables: Sebastiaan Karupu (head of delegation), Elifas Dingara, Maria Kamutali, Marina Kandumbu and Kennedy Shekupakela. Members were accompanied by Committee Clerks, Ms Agnes N. Mukono, Ms Theresia Dimba, Ms Hilde Kazongominja and Mr George Sanzila from Research, Information, Publication and Editorial Services (RIPES) as well as representatives from MEATCO and Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform (DVS).

Visit to Nkurenkuru and Mangetti Farm – Kavango Cattle Ranch on 5 and 6 July 2024

Hon Marina Kandumbu (head of delegation), Hon Gotthard Kasuto, Hon Bertha Dinyando, Hon. Johanna Kandjimi and Hon Kennedy Shekupakela accompanied by Mr Willem Isaak, Deputy Director: Committee Services.

3. METHODOLOGY

In order to obtain the necessary information and evidence relevant to the Petition, the Committee resolved to employ a mix of public hearings and onsite visits: Firstly, the Committee held consultative meetings with the Petitioners, representatives from the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform as well as MEATCO. In addition, the Committee conducted onsite visit to abattoirs and quarantine facilities in the towns and Regions listed in Section 6 below. Finally, the Committee held public hearings with the following key stakeholders:

(i) Traditional Leaders
(ii) Regional and Local Authority Councillors
(iii) Representatives from the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform,
(iv) Veterinary Services,
(v) Meat Corporation of Namibia
(vi) Meat Board of Namibia;
(vii) Namibia National Farmers Union
(viii) War Veteran Representatives
(ix) Local Civil Society Organisations
(x) Community Based Organisations and
(xi) The local media

The public hearing at Nkurenkuru, Kavango West Region held on Friday, 5 July 2024 was attended by approximately 30 participants and stakeholders consisting of the following:

(i) Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform (Directorate Veterinary Services)
(ii) Ministry of Environment, Forestry and Tourism
(iii) Kavango West Regional Council
(iv) Nkurenkuru Town Council
(v) Namibia National Farmers Union (Kavango West Regional Farmers Union)
(vi) Women Network
(vii) Namibian Police
(viii) Uukwangali Traditional Authority

The public hearing and site visit at Mangetti, Kavango Cattle Ranch held on Saturday, 6 July 2024 was attended by approximately 31 participants and stakeholders consisting of the following:

(i) Management of Mangetti Farm – Kavango Cattle Ranch employed by NIDA
(ii) Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform (Directorate Veterinary Services)
(iii) Ministry of Environment, Forestry and Tourism
(iv) All constituency councilors of Kavango West Regional Council
(v) Nkurenkuru Town Council
(vi) Namibia National Farmers Union (Kavango West Regional Farmers Union)
(vii) Women Network
(viii) Uukwangali Traditional Authority
(ix) NIDA shop stewards at Mangetti Farm

(x) Ministry of Information Communication Technology

The hearings and site visits were open to the general public and the media. To create awareness, all meetings that were conducted, notices were posted on the Parliament website and social media platform such as Facebook. All invited stakeholders were without exemption required to make a presentation and to furnish supporting evidence and documentation to assist the Committee in gathering the relevant information.

4. OBJECTIVES OF THE HEARINGS AND OVERSIGHT VISITS

The main objectives of conducting the public hearings/public consultations and onsite visits were amongst others, to:

4.1. Assess the issues and concerns raised in the petition and to find solutions to the problems, concerns and challenges, in general.

4.2. Assess the conditions of government quarantine farms, facilities receive firsthand information and experience, regarding the challenges at the government owned farms, quarantine and abattoir facilities in the NCAs.

4.3. Obtain briefings and information on how government offices, ministries and agencies uphold the mandate of veterinary services, which is to maintain and promote optimal animal health, production and reproduction and assure the safe and orderly marketing of animals and animal products through animal disease control, epidemiology, veterinary extension, veterinary public health services, diagnostic services and research.

4.4. Obtain briefings and observe the implementation and enforcement of important government functions i.e. improving livestock management and market access in the NCAs.

5. PURPOSE OF THE REPORT

The purpose of the oversight report is to inform the National Assembly about the outcome of the consultative meetings, onsite visits and public hearings in terms of findings, recommendations as well as to discuss, consider and adopt the report.

6. QUARANTINE FARMS, FACILITIES AND ABBATOIRS VISITED

6.1 Kunene Region

6.1.1. Ehomba Community Quarantine Camp
6.1.2. Otjakati Community Quarantine Camp
6.1.3. Old Slaughter House

6.2 Omusati Region

6.2.1 Omutambo Maowe Quarantine Farm
6.2.2 Outapi Abattoir (under War Veterans)

6.3 Oshana Region

6.3.1 Oshakati Eloolo Abattoir
6.3.2 Ongwediva Meat Processing Plant

6.4 Ohangwena Region

6.4.1 Eenhana Abattoir (under Liberation Veterans Association of Namibia)
6.4.2 Okongo Quarantine Farm
6.3.3 Oshivelo Quarantine Farm

6.5 Zambezi Region

6.5.1. Katima Mulilo Abattoir
6.5.2. Katima Mulilo Quarantine Camp
6.5.3. Kopano Quarantine Camp

6.6 Kavango East Region

6.6.1 Rundu Abattoir
6.6.2 Mbungu Quarantine Camp
6.6.3 Thomas Shiyave Community Camp

6.7 Kavango West Region

6.7.1 Matumbo Ribebe Quarantine Camp
6.7.2 MEATCO Mobile Slaughter Unit
6.7.3 Ncaute Auction Pen
6.7.4 Mangetti Quarantine Camp
6.7.5 Mangetti Farm – Kavango Cattle Ranch

7. CONSULTATIVE MEETINGS WITH THE PETITIONERS, MEATCO AND THE MINISTRY OF AGRICULTURE, WATER AND LAND REFORM

The Committee held consultative meetings with the above listed stakeholders before embarking on conducting onsite visits to the NCAs of Kunene, Omusati, Oshana, Ohangwena, Zambezi, Kavango East and Kavango West regions.

7.1 LISHA EMPOWERMENTAND DEVELOPMENT ORGANISATION (PETITIONERS)

The meeting with the above Petitioners, took place on 5 July 2023, to enable them clarify the main objectives of the petition before embarking on public hearings with key stakeholders.

Members were briefed on four points that are critical in ensuring that there is a market for livestock in the Northern Communal Areas namely: quarantine facilities, off takers (people buying the livestock), the quality of livestock and market access.

It was revealed during the meeting that, for nearly 12 years the physical facilities including the quarantine facility at Farm Omutambo Maowe has been in a dilapidated condition and as such facility has not been able to provide any quarantine services thus, leaving the communal farmers in Kunene, Omusati and Oshana without a market for their livestock.

Furthermore, the Meatco Abattoir at Oshakati has been closed for nearly 13 years because Meatco was unable to procure and slaughter livestock. According to the Managing Director of Lisha Empowerment and Development Organisation this was attributed to the poor quality of livestock being supplied to Meatco. He was of the opinion that livestock were not market ready, due to lack of quarantine facilities in the areas. He further stated that Meatco experienced heavy financial losses mainly because of insufficient supply of slaughter-ready livestock.

7.2 MINISTRY OF AGRICULTURE, WATER AND LAND REFORM

During the Committee's consultative meeting with the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform held on 22 November 2023 in Windhoek, members were informed that, the Ministry is guided by the legal instruments that regulate the livestock and livestock products in Namibia such as:

(i) Namibia Agricultural Policy of 2005
(ii) Agricultural Marketing Trade Policy and Strategy
(iii) Livestock Improvement Act, 27 of 1977, amongst others
(iv) Policy on Eradication of Trans-Boundary Animal Diseases
(v) Animal Health Act of 2011
(vi) Livestock Improvement Act
(vii) Meat Corporation of Namibia Act

Through the above legal instruments, the Ministry managed to secure market access for livestock and livestock products from both the North of the Veterinary Cordon Fence and south of the Veterinary Cordon fence.

The Ministry further stated that livestock and livestock products from the south of the Veterinary Cordon Fence have access to regional and international markets whereas; the northern communal areas livestock sector is still experiencing some challenges due to the following:

- The area north of the VCF is not recognized as free from FMD and CBPP mainly because of the cross-border movement of animals between the NCA and neighbouring countries Angola, Zambia and Botswana in search of grazing areas. Animals in the NCA entering neighbouring countries, contract the viruses and bring it back to Namibia.

- Non-operational abattoirs and quarantine facilities, making farmers transport animals over long distances to locate a functioning facility;
- Livestock in the northern communal areas have limited marketing channels and almost no access to lucrative markets

In an attempt to address the above challenges, the Government of Namibia through MAWLR implemented many programmes to facilitate market access for the NCA beef. Recently, the Ministry has secured market access to Qatar, Angola, Democratic Republic of the Congo and Ghana, through Commodity-Based Trade, a standard developed by the World Organisation for Animal Health to facilitate safe marketing of meat from areas that are not recognised as FMD free. Through the application of CBT, beef of the NCA is now sold south of the VCF at Meatco Wholesalers and also in Otjiwarongo. The Ministry also constructed and upgraded abattoirs in the northern communal areas namely: Katima Mulilo, Rundu, Oshakati, Eenhana and Outapi, respectively.

Despite the above achievements, farmers in the Northern Communal Areas still experience challenges in marketing their livestock due to various reasons ranging mainly from non-operational abattoirs, lack of feedlots, non-existent livestock improvement facilities and low prices.

In order to address the above challenges, the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform implemented various programmes which include, the renovation of quarantines, upgrading and construction of abattoirs, construction of meat processing plants, artificial insemination centers, feedlot and auction kraals. These projects were implemented in Zambezi, Kavango East, Kavango West, Ohangwena, Oshana, Oshikoto, Omusati and Kunene regions.

The summary of these projects are in the table below:

Activity	Slaughtering Capacity	Management/Operator
Construction and upgraded abattoirs (Katima Mulilo)	110 cattle per day	Operated by MEATCO (Export to Ghana, DRC and Angola) Can now export to Qatar subject to Halaal accreditation.
Construction and upgraded abattoirs (Rundu)	80 to 120 per day	MEATCO – since 2023
Construction and upgraded abattoirs (Oshakati)	220 per day	KIAT since 2019 but terminated in 2022 (termination under litigation)
Construction and upgraded abattoirs (Eenhana)	25 cattle per day	NNLVA since 2018
Construction and upgraded abattoirs (Outapi)	25 cattle per day	NNLVA since 2018

Eenhana Abbatoir	25 cattle per day	Operational but not slaughtering to full capacity
Meat Processing Plant Ongwediva		Under construction

However, eradication of the FMD cannot be achieved with a porous border line between Namibia and Angola as it is difficult to prevent cross border movements of livestock.

In light of the above, the Ministry proposed that, the only way to eradicate FMD is to establish a physical border movement in order to curb cross-border transmission of FMD, CBPP as well as lung sickness and other animal diseases from the neighbouring countries.

Another solution would be to consider the zoning of NCAs into disease-free compartments.

Political intervention is needed at international platforms to raise the concerns with regards trade barriers.

On Omutambo-Mawe Quarantine Farm officials from the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform stated as follows: "It is a Government farm which was established with the purpose of animal disease control and to serve the farmers in Omusati, Kunene and Oshana regions with quarantining of their cattle and small stock. The quarantine farm is very important for government to comply with CBT. **The view of the Ministry regarding the renting of Omutambo-Mawe to a private entity, is that private entities have not been effective in delivering cost effective veterinary services to less endowed farmers.**

7.3 CONSULTATIVE MEETING WITH MEATCO

During a consultative meeting with MEATCO that took place in June 2023, the company appealed for policy interventions to solve challenges it is faced with such as lack of working capital to carry out its operations due to a massive fall in its market share in recent years as a result of underutilization of its abattoirs.

Meatco further revealed that farmers in the NCAs can now breathe a sigh of relief following the discovery of a lucrative market for their animals in countries such as Ghana, Democratic Republic of Congo and the Gulf cooperation countries among others.

7.4 COUNTER RESPONSES BY THE PETITIONERS

Reviving the Livestock Market, Farmers' Livelihoods and Trust in Government Cooperation – *Counter Responses to the Views Expressed by MAWLR Representatives at the Hearing on the LISHA Petition* held on 22 November 2023

(a) Specific Concerns of the LISHA Petition

In the NCAs, any effective quarantine facility is a key instrument – not only to ensure delivery of healthy slaughter-ready animals to abattoirs, but also serves to incentivize and enhance growth of local farming activities, profitability of operations and sustenance of

livelihoods of many thousands of resident households. Despite this fact, the quarantine facility at Farm Omutambo Omawe has been allowed to be nearly destroyed –due to negligence, non-commitment and compromise of developmental best practices.

(b) A comparative Analysis of Conditions - Infrastructure from Takeover to Present

The table below present pertinent cases demonstrating how the facility has been mismanaged since takeover to date –through sheer negligence and non-commitment to practicing developmental best practices.

Table 1: *List of Infrastructure*

Item No.	**Description**	**Available at Takeover** *(after 1990)*	**Available at Present** *(2023)*
1.	Number of functional boreholes	13	1 *(functional – provides water to houses only)*
2.	Number of borehole engines	**13**	**1** *(others broken or went missing)*
3.	Number of power generators	**1**	**1** *(not functional for last 9 years)*
4.	Number and integrity of camps	**26**	**8** *(all without water)*
5.	Number of quarantine camps	**8**	**2** *(without water)*
6.	Integrity of pipelines	Good integrity *(reportedly)*	Very questionable *(The one used for supplying water to houses is repaired with wire and rubber)*
7.	Integrity of fencing	Good integrity *(reportedly)*	In dilapidated conditions *(destroyed by fire in many places due to lack of environmental management plan against fire outbreaks; many without poles and droppers and lie on the due to lack of maintenance)*
8.	Maintenance of Infrastructure	Reportedly, was being done at first *(during early years of takeover)*	Totally neglected *(for 13 years to date)*

Comments:

a) ***The facility is challenged by dilapidated conditions to the extent it is impossible to utilize it for any quarantine services without carrying out extensive and costly repairs;***
b) ***Claims by ministerial officials that repairs were being undertaken at the facility are unfounded;***

c) ***Ministerial claims of intent to utilize the facility to quarantine small livestock bound for the southern part of red line anytime soon enough remains a dream in futility as there is not any water resources at camps earmarked for this intervention.***

(c) The Impacts of Current Conditions at the Facility

The adverse conditions at the facility did not only serve to prevent rendering of livestock health services in the target regions, but have also severely eliminated the possibility for abattoirs at Oshakati and Outapi to procure market-ready slaughter animals in sustainable quantities. This persistent situation remains inextricably linked to the subsequent closure of the two abattoirs since about 11 years ago – with consequent impacts of hunger, poverty and desperate hopelessness too ghastly to contemplate.

(d) Specific Objectives of the Petition

The main object of the petition was to convey to national parliament the desires of the respective regional councils, traditional authorities and farmers' associations as authoritative representatives of the farming populace in the target regions. This is after, some of these institutions had pleaded with the MAWLR for transformational interventions without any response. Such pleas included:

a) that, Omutambo facility be restored and its intended services be resumed urgently;
b) that, closed abattoirs be re-opened to allow procurement/sale of livestock in order to combat prevailing poverty and ensure resilient livelihoods.

As community pleas were effectively ignored, leaders of some of communities in traditional authorities in Kunene and Omusati regions approached Super Group of Companies requesting the company to consider applying for rental of the quarantine facility on the basis of a public-private- partnership with MAWLR/*DVS*.

Super Group of Companies is well-known for their philanthropic work in Kunene region where they had constructed and donated a solar-powered fuel station to the community of Omakange as one of their free service offerings.

(e) Transformational services offered by Super Group of Companies

In a positive response to the pleas of communities affected by the destruction of Omutambo quarantine facility, the Super Group of Companies requested the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform for an opportunity to rent the facility at N$120 000 per annum, in addition to the following offers:

(i) Repair and restore, for free of charge, the 8 camps used for quarantine purposes by DVS – who should continue to provide animal health services at the facility during the period of rental.
(ii) Repair and/or replace, for free of charge, the broken or missing water pump engines at the facility in order to restore water supply services.
(iii) On a gradual basis, repair all fences at the facility for free of charge in order to restore their integrity, including creating buffer zones between the camps that hold livestock under quarantine and those that would hold procured livestock to be prepared for

market readiness, in order to prevent disease, transfer from untreated livestock to those under treatment.

(iv) Kick-start a livestock improvement programme involving:

a) Producing annually 100 stud bulls for free distribution to farming communities under the jurisdiction of target traditional authorities in order to improve the genetic value of slaughter animals, quality and profitability of meat when procured for slaughter;
b) Procuring available livestock raised by farming communities within the jurisdiction of target traditional authorities at market-related prices as applicable in all parts across Namibia. Such animals would be temporarily held in renovated camps at the facility for market-readiness before delivery to off-taker abattoirs. For this purpose, a small-scale to medium-sized feedlot would be established at the facility to improve animal weights.
c) Constructing to establish, for free of charge, a primary school and a clinic in the vicinity of the facility to provide respective education and health services for surrounding communities whose residents, currently, obtain such services from Opuwo – some 60 km away.

(f) Support of Proposed SGC Services

The transformational services offered by Super Group of Companies enjoy the full support of the following institutions within the target areas, whose letters of support were presented to LISHA, namely:

a. Regional Councils

- Kunene Regional Council
- Omusati Regional Council

b. Traditional Authorities

- Uukwaluudhi Traditional Authority
- Ombalantu Traditional
- Ongandjera Traditional Authority
- Uukwambi Traditional Authority
- Ondonga Traditional Authority

c. DVS Representative Office

- DVS Office at Outapi, Omusati Region

d. Religious Institutions

- Western Diocese, Evangelical Lutheran Church in Namibia.

(g) LISHA's Plea for Relief

Given the situational analysis presented above, the reported constrained budget allocations to MAWLR due to scarcity of development funds, and the proven fact that, quite often, the ministry officials remain too economical with the truth on matters reflective of general in-competencies, the petitioners firmly believe that existing conditions will continue to persist for years to come if renovation of the quarantine facility and resumption of the market is not complemented with progressive outside assistance.

It is therefore their sincere plea that, in the interest of the populace in target areas, the Standing Committee recommends to National Assembly for favourable consideration of Super Group of Companies' service offerings as submitted.

(h) Bill of Quantities

In a document titled "Schedule of 5-year Bill of Quantities for Rehabilitation and upgrading of quarantine facilities at Farm Omutambo Maowe in Omusati Region – proposed for a public-private partnership" submitted to the Committee in July 2024, Super Group of Companies proposed a total investment of Sixteen Million Nine Hundred and Thirty-Three and Two Hundred and Thirty Five Thousand Namibia Dollar (N$16 933 235.00) on this project, should the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform agree to a public-private partnership agreement.

8. FINDINGS, OBSERVATIONS AND DISCUSSIONS

8.1 MEETING WITH KEY STAKEHOLDERS

During the key stakeholder's meeting in Kunene region, members were informed that the livestock quarantine facilities intended to assist farmers manage and market their livestock are either non-functional or have been totally vandalized. About three livestock quarantine camps have fallen victim to vandalism, further jeopardizing opportunities for farmers to sell their animals in formal markets. They proposed that the government should come up with a permanent/fixed abattoir and meanwhile, while waiting for such initiative, there is a need to put up a mobile abattoir in Kunene region.

According to the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform, a contractor will soon be appointed to upgrade the Opuwo Slaughter House and Omutambo Maowe Quarantine Farm that serves livestock farmers in the Kunene, Omusati and Oshana regions.

A representative from MEATCO also who formed part of the delegation noted that, the company was also in the process of resuming its operations through what is referred to as commodity-based-trade, that entails buying livestock from farmers in the Omusati region and surrounding areas for quarantine in local camps before transporting them to MEATCO operated export abattoirs of Rundu and Katima Mulilo.

It was noted during the meeting in Oshana region that, market access for livestock in the region is almost non-existence due to the absence of abattoirs and non-functional quarantine facilities. Stakeholders repeated the same sentiments adding that, the veterinary cordon fence, which they described as a discriminatory policy has been adversely affecting local farmers. They are calling for the upgrade of livestock quarantine and abattoir facilities that are not operating, questioning private operators' capacities to run such facilities. They also proposed a multi-sectoral approach in solving the challenge of lack of livestock market in the Northern Communal Areas.

During the stakeholder engagement in Ohangwena region, livestock producers stressed that, they do not have access to a market because of the VCF Policy also referred to as the redline. The marketing of the cattle from the NCAs is restricted by the VCF, as livestock producers, north of the VCF are not allowed to freely market their animals to the SVCF due to FMD and CBPP restrictions. They are calling for the shifting of the so-called Redline to the border with Angola with the continuous imposition of strict animal health protocols.

The only abattoir in the area catering for local farmers for meat destined for the local market, is not fully functional. Farmers in the area are selling their livestock informally at low prices compared to their counterparts, south of the veterinary cordon fence.

They further complained about lack of grazing due to drought adding that, the situation has forced many local farmers to look for grazing area in neighboring Angola, calling for diplomatic solution between the two countries.

The Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform, proposed that farmers lacked information as there are various options they could exploit to market their livestock, such as the CBT, that entails selling the livestock to MEATCO to be kept at Okongo quarantine farm for animal health control purposes as is per requirement for export bound animals. He further urged farmers to organize themselves and sell their animals as a unit in order to reduce costs. He implored government to subsidize farmers in times of drought and capacitate them through trainings.

The farmers further expressed their dissatisfaction regarding the lack of grazing for their animals due to the large tract of fenced land occupied by the farm (Oshivelo Quarantine) that is not fully utilized.

Officials from the Veterinary services are of the opinion that the porous border between Namibia and Angola presents a risk for livestock as they end up mixing with animals that may not be vaccinated. They further noted that, the proposed canal planned to be built in Northern Namibia will help control the movement of livestock.

8.3 ONSITE VISITS TO QUARANTINE AND ABATTOIR FACILITIES

8.3.1 KUNENE REGION

8.3.1.1 Ehomba Community Quarantine Camp

The camp which is located over hundred kilometers north of Opuwo is the only facility still in good condition in Kunene region and has a carrying capacity of over hundred (100) cattle.

Despite its good condition, it is not being used for its primary purpose, since MEATCO stopped operations in the area and instead, it is leased to a local businessman who runs an abattoir.

The facility was built by government with the assistance from the Millennium Challenge Account and was inaugurated in 2000 with the purpose to assist farmers in the NCAs to market their livestock and increase agricultural productivity. It was initially operated by MEATCO and has stopped activities since 2014 following the loss of the South African market due to outbreak of animal diseases.

8.3.1.2 Old Slaughter House

The Committee visited the Old Slaughter House which belongs to the Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade. The building was abandoned in 2016 and is currently managed by a businessman who runs the place to avoid vandalism. However, such a facility is in a dilapidated state hence, requires major renovations. Members were informed that plans are under way to renovate the slaughter house and upgrade it to slaughter small livestock. The Committee further visited Otjakati Community Quarantine Camp which is vandalized.

8.3.2 OMUSATI REGION

8.3.2.1 Omutambo Maowe Quarantine Camp

The above quarantine camp has not been operational following MEATCO's closure of its operations in 2015. The facility is over thirty thousand (30 000) hectares in size, divided into 31 camps with 23 livestock and 8 small stock and has not carried any cattle in the NNCAs for slaughter in ten (10) years, except for the seventy-five (75) state-owned cattle held for the purpose of testing quarantined animals for FMD and other animal diseases.

According to officials at the facility, three camps at the quarantine farm were in good working condition and ready to accommodate cattle for the market, should MEATCO decide to resume operations. The dormancy of the facility, including the absence of abattoir has irked or unpleased many farmers in the area who feel that they are being deliberately sidelined in the marketing of their livestock.

The lack of grazing area, worsened by a large tract of fenced quarantine land, has further resulted in conflict as farmer's animals scramble for limited grazing. There have been repeated appeals from farmers to allow them to graze their animals in the quarantine camps, particularly, during drought season. This situation has resulted in some Farmers setting up fire to burn the grass (wild fire), they proposed that the government of the Republic of Namibia should cut-off the grass and sell to farmers at low or reasonable price.

Some of the challenges highlighted at the facility include the following:

(i) Non -operational of electrical engine for the past fourteen to fifteen years
(ii) Absence of a grader to clear the grass inside the camp
(iii) There are quite a number of potholes and wild animals such as lions and snakes that kills quarantined animals.

8.3.2.2 Outapi Abattoir

Outapi abattoir being privately run as a joint venture between a local businessman and the Namibia Liberation Struggle Association has experienced disruptions in its operations since the signing of the agreement with the government in 2014. Such disruptions have been as a result of the poor state of equipment such as the broken pipes and the septic pump system earmarked to remove manure and blood, leaving farmers in the area with no lucrative market to sell their livestock that exceed two thousand (2000).

The Hygiene Inspector declared the facility to be in an unhygienic state of condition and output from the facility is not fit for human consumption. There is also no cold storage hence, the Meat Processing Plant is needed.

The construction of the Ongwediva meat processing plant meant to process and add value to meat products in the areas has also stalled or stopped and many meat suppliers now resort to sourcing meat products south of the red line.

8.3.3 OSHANA REGION

8.3.3.1 Oshakati Eloolo Abattoir

The Eloolo Export Abattoir has not been operational since its leasing to the Liberation Veterans Association of Namibia due to its dilapidated state, leaving farmers with no access to a market. The Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform has revoked the abattoir's operating license in 2022 due to previous operation's mismanagement.

8.3.3.2 Ongwediva Meat Processing Plant

The Committee inspected the aforesaid facility whose construction began in 2014 and completed in 2022 but yet to be inaugurated. Its purpose is to assist local abattoirs store and process animals into meat for consumption and to sell meat to local super markets.

The processing Plant together with Eenhana abattoir was awarded to the Liberation Struggle. The government of the Republic of Namibia through the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform is required to finalize the completion of such facility. Although the facility is not fully completed due to the air conditioning it is about 95 percent complete.

Currently, African Meat Supplier is the only potential client for the Eenhana abattoirs but they have their own meat processing plant.

8.3.4 OHANGWENA REGION

8.3.4.1 Eenhana Abattoir

The aforesaid abattoir is fully operational and equipped and has the slaughtering capacity of fifteen (15) cattle per day with an average of 40 to 50 cattle only for African Meat Supply. The part of deboning is missing at the slaughter house and there is no storage place.

8.3.4.2 Okongo Quarantine Farm

The above farm which measures over 18 000 hectares is subdivided into eleven (11) camps (3 core area under wildlife and 8 operational camps). The facility is being used by MEATCO to quarantine livestock bought from farmers through commodity-based trade, for its Rundu abattoir for export.

During the Committee's visit, there were 95 livestock kept in the facility with the carrying capacity of over 800 cattle as well as a section of the quarantine that has been turned into a core area for wildlife.

The livestock which were kept at the facility were relocated from Matumbo Ribebe quarantine camp which is 50km west of Rundu in Kavango West region and is in a dilapidated condition. According to Meatco operations Manager, the Rundu abattoir recently obtained the export status hence, the decision to translocate livestock to Okongo quarantine farm that can offer veterinary services necessary for export bound animals.

Members were further informed that, local farmers in the Ohangwena region had the option to sell their livestock to MEATCO directly for local market without having to go through the process of quarantine.

8.3.5 OSHIKOTO REGION

8.3.5.1 Oshivelo Quarantine Camp

The above quarantine camp remains underutilized since 2009 due to non-operation of abattoirs as a result of the closure of MEATCO operations in the NCAs.

The facility which was mostly keeping livestock meant for the Oshakati abattoir, currently only quarantines small livestock for farmers who wish to relocate their livestock south of the redline. During the Committee's visit, there were hundred and forty-three (143) small stock animals that were confiscated and awaiting a decision from the Chief Master as to whether to be detained or destroyed.

The 29 000-hectare quarantine farm which is subdivided into 19 camps has also been a target for vandals who continuously damage their fence, risking the health of quarantined animals. Water infrastructure such as reservoirs are also in a dilapidated state.

Officials who run the facility further complained about lack of transport coupled by poor road conditions, poor network, lack of water for instance, officials at the facility have to walk a distance of 8 km to fetch water. One borehole is not working due to the pump that need to be procured since 2009.

Officials raised concern about the Public Procurement Amendment Act, 3 of 2022. There is also lack of electricity, water and poor network as well as vandalism of facilities and lots of snakes.

The borehole which used to operate on generator is currently not operational due to difficulties in obtaining parts and the proposal was to switch to the solar system. The kraals at the two farms are broken and Pos 1 (borehole), the Lister pump is in good condition but the reservoir is not working whereas; Pos 2 (borehole), engine pump (tank), reservoir is broken, Pos 3 (borehole), all reservoirs are broken and Pos 4 (borehole), situated at the facility (home), is in good condition whereas; the pump and the tanks to put water are broken.

8.3.6 ZAMBEZI REGION

8.3.6.1 Katima Mulilo Abattoir

The abattoir was initially a butchery before it was upgraded to an abattoir. It is registered by Meat Board with export status (class A), exporting meat to Ghana. In terms of staffing, there are 60 and the slaughtering capacity is 110 per week. The limitation for the chiller capacity is 110 hence, the need to expand the chiller capacity.

8.3.6.2 Katima Mulilo Quarantine Camp

The above camp which measures 8000 hectares has seven camps but has not been operational since 2014. The quarantine has been vandalized for many years, no fence and water within the quarantine and there is quite a number of police cases being reported.

Such facility was supposed to be revamped under the American fund (EDF 11) however, the funds were not released hence, it was diverted to Kopano quarantine camp.

8.3.6.3 Kopano Quarantine Camp

The quarantine camp which measures 13 000 hectares serves the entire Zambezi region and part of Mukwe Constituency in Kavango East region.

The camp is sub divided into 12 camps and has challenges such as; stock theft, lack of water provision at some camps particularly, from camp 10 to 12, The only camps with water provision is from camp 1 to 9.

Members were informed that, continuous vandalism is taking place at the camp, especially at camp 12 which is along the Namibia-Zambia border. People normally cut the fence to gain entry into the quarantine to illegally harvest timber. Such situation was said to pose threat to the biosecurity of Namibia due to the fact that, once the Namibian animals access exit through the cut fence, they will be in contact with other animals that are not quarantined from the side of Zambia.

It was revealed during the site visit that, from January to April 2024, 640 cattle were quarantined at Kopano and later slaughtered at Katima Mulilo abattoir and during such visit, there were 940 cattle in quarantine, waiting to be slaughtered.

8.3.7 KAVANGO EAST REGION

8.3.7.1 Mbungu Community Quarantine Camp

The above camp measures 1 400 hectares and was constructed in 2000. It is managed by the community under the custodian of the Mbukushu Traditional Leader. The facility serves as marketing and repatriation quarantine.

The camp which is divided into two camps stopped its operations in 2014/2015 when Meatco pulled out its operations.

When Meatco withdrew its services, both MEATCO, Traditional Leaders and the Directorate of Veterinary Services were not proactive hence, communities were not properly informed. There is no ministerial staff at the quarantine. The Quarantine Committee is in place and the reason why DVS does not have a permanent staff at the

facility is due to the fact that, the custody of such facility is vested in the Quarantine Committee and the Traditional Leaders and DVS only assist with maintenance.

Although there is Guard/Security Officer at the premises, lots of assets were stolen such as the wire. Since the fence is open, communities graze their animals outside and there is a borehole in place including a 10 000 litre water tank where communities fetch water.

8.3.7.2 Thomas Shiyave Community Quarantine Camp

The above captioned quarantine camp is under the custodian of the Giriku Traditional Authority. Although there is a caretaker responsible for the safe guard of such facility and has been there for more than 18 years, the camp is vandalized by the surrounding communities and items were stolen although some were recovered. Lots of stolen cases were opened and reported at the Police Station and the problem was lack of evidence. The staff at the facility informed Members that, there is a need to procure some materials in order to revamp or revive such quarantine.

8.3.7.3 Rundu Abattoir

Rundu Abattoir was finally handed over to Meatco as the operator on 31 August 2023. The abattoir now provides cattle farmers in the Kavango East region, Kavango West region, Tsumkwe Constituency in Otjozondjupa region, Ohangwena region, and Oshikoto region with a market to sell their cattle and generate income. Apart from providing market for cattle farmers, the opening of the Rundu abattoir has created employment and stimulated economic activities downstream to SMEs who are purchasing products for reselling.

Rundu Abattoir is an export-approved abattoir certified by the DVS and registered by the Livestock and Livestock Products Board of Namibia and has a workforce of 64 fixed-term employees (8 casuals at the abattoir and 58 at quarantine camps), bringing the total to 130 employees.

The abattoir can slaughter 13,440 cattle through block slaughtering mode or 24,000 cattle through full slaughtering mode per annum. In block slaughtering, the same team that slaughters are responsible for deboning. With full slaughtering, separate teams handle slaughtering and deboning.

During this financial year (2024/2025), Meatco has budgeted to slaughter 6,000 cattle at Rundu abattoir. To date, 3026 cattle have been slaughtered, and 397 farmers have sold their cattle, resulting in N$20.7 million paid to farmers.

Although Meatco is committed to delivering on its public policy mandate that is to procure, slaughter, process, market beef locally and abroad, Meatco Rundu abattoir is faced with some challenges that hampers its operations such as the following:

(i) Lack of Functional Quarantine Camps

Rundu abattoir operates under Commodity Based Trade, which requires cattle to be quarantined at the DVS approved quarantine camp. Currently, only Matumbo Ribebe Quarantine Camp is functional. However, DVS has procured materials to renovate Mbungu and Thomas Shiyave Quarantine Camps. Renovation at Mbungu Quarantine camp has been completed, and the first intake of cattle is scheduled to take place in the beginning of September 2024. This will provide a market to farmers in Mukwe constituency who have been deprived of a formal livestock market. Repair at Thomas Shiyave Quarantine has also started and is expected to be completed in November 2024. This project is implemented jointly with Meatco.

(ii) Lack of Feeder Roads

The lack of feeder roads is hindering agricultural productivity, profitability, and marketing in the Kavango East region. Despite having about 300 Small Scale Commercial Farming Units (SSCFU), there are no feeder roads connecting farms to main roads. This is making it difficult for farmers to deliver cattle to the abattoir. The current roads are causing breakdowns to cars and trucks.

(iii) Lack of 4x4 cattle trucks

Most farmers are farming inland requiring 4x4 trucks to transport the animals to the abattoir. However, there is a serious shortage of 4x4 trucks, making it difficult for farmers to transport their cattle. The Livestock Support Project, funded by the European Development Fund 11, has a budget to purchase 4x4 trucks to address this issue, but the trucks have not yet been delivered to the abattoirs.

(iv) Declining quality of cattle during the dry season (August – December)

Given the price disparity between farmers in the commercial areas and in the NCA, it is expensive for farmers in the NCA to keep cattle in good condition throughout the year. This results in farmers supplying cattle of declined quality during the dry season. There is, therefore, a need for the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform to allocate to Meatco a site for feedlot and fodder production at any Green Scheme within the proximity of Rundu abattoir. This shall stimulate weaner production and ensure continuous slaughter of cattle of good quality throughout the year.

(v) An omission of important infrastructures at the abattoir

The abattoir was built without an incinerator, kitchen, workshop and hides store room. These are all important infrastructures at the abattoir, which are not on the Rundu abattoir plan, which is a serious omission from those who were involved in planning the abattoir. This is impacting negatively on the performance and the operation of the abattoir.

In light of the above challenges, it should be noted that, the presence of the Rundu abattoir has the potential to improve the living standards of cattle farmers and contribute to the development of Kavango East.

Such abattoir plays an important role in the livestock sector value chain of the region and It is an important contributor to the region's economic development hence, it requires support from local leadership from all spheres.

8.3.8 KAVANGO WEST REGION

8.3.8.1 Matumbo Ribebe Quarantine Camp and Mobile Slaughter Unit

The above camp and slaughter unit are located at the same place. During the site visit, Members were informed that, the Slaughter Unit was bought by MEATCO in 2016 with the purpose to move from one region to the other.

Due to the high supply of cattle, the unit could not be moved and currently, assessments are underway to establish as to whether the unit should remain at Matumbo Ribebe or should be moved to Opuwo.

8.3.8.2 Ncaute Auction Pen

The structure was constructed under the Millennium Challenge Account (MCA) fund and started operational in 2023. There is a subsection for Veterinary services hence, there are no Offices.

There are two houses for veterinary services officials which were constructed in 2015 but not yet completed. As a result, the Constructor abandoned the facility in 2017 with no Security on site to guard the premises. However, there are casual workers on site who guards the premises. Windows are broken and the electricity is connected to the generator.

8.3.8.3 Nkurenkuru and Mangetti Farm – Kavango Cattle Ranch

(a) Jurisdiction

The Mangetti including the Kavango Cattle Ranch falls under Tondoro constituency and Kavango West Regional Council.

(b) Cattle Population

The Cattle population in Kavango West Region is estimated at 180, 000 to 198, 000.

(c) Northern Communal Area Fence

Most participants were of the view that the Northern Communal Area Fence and the so-called Redline is not benefiting the farming sector and communities in the northern regions of the country.

(d) Functions, duties and performance of State Veterinary Services

The State Veterinarian (Animal Disease Control) is the head responsible at operational level of all state veterinary and administrative matters in the veterinary district assigned to him/her. Most duties/instructions/responsibilities are covered by Circulars/Treasury Instructions/Legislation with respect to the veterinary profession, animal diseases,

veterinary medicine, hygiene control, animal brands, animal identification, animal movements, import/export protocols and agreements, management of staff members and training etcetera.

Approximately 150, 000 cattle were vaccinated in the region whilst in 2022, there was an outbreak of lung sickness. DVS also provide animal health care awareness to farmers.

(e) Challenges and Shortcomings in Nkurenkuru and Kavango West Region

(i) Shortage of staff and manpower: the region is vast and the existing personnel cannot cater for all individual farmers;
(ii) Bad road network – It is difficult to reach some parts of the region when we are conducting vaccination/tagging campaigns or attending to sick animals;
(iii) Vaccine delivery: the delay in delivery of FMD and CBPP vaccines, which hinders the office to vaccinate cattle timely and reach the targeted 80% vaccination coverage in order to achieve herd immunity;
(iv) Vaccines are delivered when animals are in poor body condition making it very difficult for some farmers to present their animals for vaccination as they fear that the poorly conditioned animals will die after getting vaccinated;
(v) Shortage of vehicles;
(vi) Vaccines are received late from Windhoek; and
(vii) Animals should be vaccinated twice per year at least, to access the market.

For farmers to partake in the **commodity-based trade** the following requirements must be adhered to:

(viii) Cattle must be vaccinated against FMD at least twice, with the last vaccination not more than 6 months and not less than 30 days prior to slaughter. This procedure is a challenge because of late delivery of vaccines, leading to most cattle not qualifying for CBT;
(ix) Some Cattle presented at Rundu Abattoir are in a very bad body condition as farmers do not supplement their cattle with required feed and vitamins to gain good condition, because farmers are living in poverty and cannot afford to buy feed and vitamins for the animals.

(f) Infrastructure and Facilities: availability of quarantine facilities and abattoirs

(i) In the Kavango West Region, under the Nkurenkuru State Veterinary Office, there is no Quarantine facility or Abattoir. Matumbo Rebebe Quarantine falls under Rundu State Veterinary office and Mangetti Farm falls under Grootfontein State Veterinary Office.
(ii) Participants also made the following contributions:
    (a) Quarantine camps in the Kavango West Region are not functional;
    (b) There is need for upgrading crush pens, auction pens, quarantine camps, slaughter-houses and abattoirs in Nkurenkuru and all constituencies including the Mangetti Farm-Kavango Cattle Ranch;
    (c) There are no proper roads to quarantine camps, auction pens and abattoirs;
    (d) There are no fodder production and feedlot facilities in the Kavango West Region;
    (e) Crush pens for loading of animals on trucks for auction need to be upgraded in

Nkurenkuru and the entire Kavango West region. Some officials of the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform promised to provide trucks to communal farmers to transport their livestock to auction pens;

(f) Rural electrification should be rolled out to all the constituencies in the region including Charlie Camp to provide for cold storage facilities and fridges when livestock are slaughtered by communal farmers;

(g) More boreholes should be drilled at Nkurenkuru and all the constituencies in Kavango West Region because water is urgently needed;

(h) Rundu abattoir is underutilized; and

(i) A monitoring and evaluation system should be established to enable farmers to make optimal use of their farming units.

(g) Market access and Livestock Value Chain

(i) The submission of the Directorate Veterinary Services at Nkukerenkuru is that farmers in the Kavango West Region market their animals at Mpasinkuru Auction Pen, Rundu abattoir, Musese feedlot, Kakuro Cattle post and individual farmers mostly from the Northern West Regions;

(ii) Nkurenkuru State Vet Office facilitates the marketing of these animals through issuing of movement permits after verifying that the animals are complying with all relevant circulars and memoranda and according to the Animal Health Act 1 of 2011;

(iii) The general view of most participants was that there is no market access and value chain for livestock in the Kavango West Region, hampering sustainable farming. Farmers have expressed their dissatisfaction because there is no market for the cattle. Furthermore, it was stated that marketers have dropped cattle prices to N$17 and N$12 per kilogram. It was claimed that marketers sell cattle to the Government at N$20 per kg, especially when hosting national events;

(iv) MAWLR made a commitment and promise to develop a strategy for market access and to improve the prices of cattle to be comparable to cattle in the south but up to now, that strategy is not implemented;

(v) NNFU strongly advised that communal farmers need to have access through the union

(h) MANGETTI FARM - KAVANGO CATTLE RANCH

The Mangetti Farm also known as Kavango Cattle Ranch is located in the Tondoro Constituency of the Kavango West Region. The farm size is approximate 230 000 hectares.

The following contributions were made at the public hearing and site visit:

(i) Farm background

(a) The farm dates back as far as 1973 when it was managed in the apartheid era by a corporation called BBK;

(b) The farm went through a transition, and it was later managed by ENOK, AMCOM, NDC and now NIDA;

(c) According to the Uukwangali Traditional Authority, they were the historical owners of the land during the colonial and post-colonial period, where Mangetti Farm is and they provided the land to ENOK, Amcom and NDC with the understanding that their subjects should benefit from the farm. Now, they want to be part of the decision-making and management bodies of Kavango Cattle Ranch for their subjects to benefit.

(ii) Farm overview

(a) The farm size is approximately 223,894 hectares, including Mangetti West Carrying capacity is estimated at +-18,000 herds of cattle at 12.4:1 ha/LSU;
(b) Cattle herd size by the end of June 2024 is 9,247 cattle (KCR – 7,024 and MW 2,223);
(c) Average annual rainfall is 450 mm;
(d) Divisions MW and Section 1-5, 38 farming units;
(e) Permanent employees at the farm 65 and temporary employees are 46. There are 120 casual employees contracted on short terms;
(f) The farm throughput under 1,500 herd per annum is over N$18,2 million;
(g) There is potential for over 2,500 herd per annum with a throughput over N$30.4 million; and
(h) KCR should be regarded as 'the mine' in the Kavango West Region.

(iii) Community Overview

(a) The population of the community at the farm is estimated at approximately 2,000 people;
(b) School starts from Grade 1 to 9;
(c) Directorate Veterinary Services manages quarantine camps and provide a service to NIDA and surrounding farms;
(d) There is a clinic for health services;
(e) There is good MTC network tower and electrical services are provided by CENORED;
(f) Elephants destroy crop fields, thereby threating food security.

(iv) Farm Practices

(a) KCR farms with the *Santa Gertrudis* and *Brahman* cattle breed.
(b) The farm was initially an ox production system.
(c) The production systems impact on cash flow or requires investment over a period of time.
(d) In the new business plan, the system is changed to mix production of weaners and ox striking a balance. Adopting the weaner production system requires a well-developed farming setup for the market.
(e) The system is expected to ensure a cash flow for the farm.
(f) Each farm post is manned by 2 cattle staff.

(v) Cattle marketing

(a) The farm management planned to market 3,000 cattle (direct slaughter and weaners) during the 2024/2025 FY with an estimated revenue of approximately N$35 million; and
(b) To date, the farm has marketed 450 cattle yielding N$5 million

(vi) Elephant and wild dog history

(a) The elephant population in 2010 was approximately 30. In September 2022, the population was 134 elephants;
(b) A technical committee between NIDA and MEFT was established to address human-wildlife conflict including damaging of crop field and fences along the Mangetti Farm; an
(c) A MoU was drafted to mitigate the measures being implemented.

(vii) Elephant water infrastructure

(a) Two water points were planned for section 5 and 1 was completed and installed at post 49; and
(b) The pumping unit was stolen. A replacement was made but the borehole was tampered with.

(viii) Weaknesses, challenges and shortcomings at Mangetti Farm – Kavango Cattle Ranch

The participants made the following comments raising a myriad of weaknesses, challenges and shortcomings at Mangetti Farm:

(a) ***Infrastructure and Quarantine Facilities***

- Quarantine camps are used for disease control and marketing of livestock. The quarantine camps at Mangetti Farm are not functional at all because of the damages to infrastructure caused by elephants. The quarantine camps have not been fully operational for the past fourteen to fifteen years -it was during 2007 and 2012 when the Mangetti quarantine camp was functional and utilized;
- Ninety-five percent (95%) of the water infrastructure is damaged and the dilapidated water tower on the farm is on the verge of collapsing. Cattle started dying because they did not get enough water.
- There is poor or sometimes no network reception on the farm.
- There was a fueling station on the farm but not functional anymore and fuel is received in drums from Tsumeb.

(b) **Alleged mismanagement and irregularities**

- It was alleged that there is mismanagement and irregularities at Mangetti Farm. Cattle are being relocated to private farms and that there are a lot of underhand dealings and schemes allegedly going on at the farm.
- There is limited rangeland management capacity and skills; and limited monitoring and control.
- The husbandry practices are challenged;
- The following requests were made:
  - Transition from NDC to NIDA should be attended to and finalized;
  - NIDA should foster and strengthen its relationship with the workers;
  - Government should consider the cancellation of the contract with NIDA and appoint another company (on public-private partnership basis) that will run this large Cattle Farm in a better way.

(c) ***Reservations about the herd quantity of cattle***

- Previously, the camp had twenty-one thousand (21 000) head of cattle and during the Committee's visit there were only nine thousand (9 000) head of cattle. The

number of cattle provided by NIDA is not a true reflection of the actual herd on the farm hence the actual cattle on the farm is a big concern, impacting on accountability – it is estimated at 12 000.

- Cattle are being moved from the farm to Oshikoto region under the pretext that it will be brought back.
- Cattle was restocked in 2010 and 2011 and those in good condition are being sold.
- In 2022, cattle were buried at KCR leading to the suspension of the CEO and in 2023, 660 cattle were sold for +-N$4,7 million.
- Managers called Meat Corporation but there is no witness when cattle are loaded because the cattle herder was not allowed to be present;

(d) ***Alleged theft and damage of property***

- Some of the findings include an increase in stock theft and equipment such as solar panels and water pumps. Theft is on the increase on the farm. The allegation that fences are being damaged is not entirely true because there is syndicate who allegedly steal cattle.
- Two hundred (200) bundles of steel wire to repair broken fences were lost and 5 x 20 litre chemicals were stolen and the suspicion is that it was an inside job. Solar panels have also been stolen.
- Before the incumbent farm manager was posted to the farm in August 2022, theft was rampant. When he arrived, the key to the store room and safe was accessible. He proposed that the Committee recommend the investigation of the allegations.

(e) ***Human-Wildlife Conflict – Elephants***

- Infrastructure including fences are being destroyed frequently by elephants.
- Although employees are entitled to danger allowances for dealing with wild animals such as elephants and buffaloes, they are not compensated.
- Elephants are causing trauma to the workers and cattle; and sometimes mortalities of livestock when they do not find water. As a result, employees leave cattle posts because they fear being attacked and killed by elephants.

(f) ***Poor labour relations and low morale of employees***

- Employees at the farm have no employment contracts with NIDA since the transition between NDC and NIDA.
- Employee morale is very low due to 'bad' labour relations impacting adversely on production. Workers are not satisfied with their condition of service and remuneration.
- Workers representatives present informed the Committee that the N$3180 salary per month to a herder and the increase of 4.5% is simply not a decent and living wage. A truck operator or section manager is also paid the same wage. They expressed dissatisfaction and informed the committee that they were promised N$10 000 per month by the board chairperson.
- At the time of the Committee's visit there was an industrial action which was just resolved the day before. During the period of visiting the farm, cattle were left without water.
- Some workers are being victimized by the NIDA board and management;

- They raised concerns about inadequate housing for employees and lack of regular training on cattle herding and farm maintenance.

(g) **Past ministerial commitments and promises**

- The Minister of Industrialisation and Trade allegedly made some promises to find solutions to the current situation at the farm but nothing has happened since then.
- In the past, the Minister of Industrialisation and Trade and Minister of Finance and Public Enterprises were invited by the KWRC to find an amicable solution.
- A board was constituted to run Mangetti on behalf of the Executive and a myriad of problems were raised.
- The Executive is still in a process to find a solution but the situation at the farm is deteriorating and getting worse.
- When the minister instituted the board, the minister was supposed to include the traditional authority and regional council because that is where the land belongs.

(h) **Non-involvement of the regional council and traditional authority**

Although the Mangetti Farm is situated in Kavango West region under Tondoro Constituency, such camps are not being administered by the management of Kavango West Regional Council and the Uukwangali Traditional Authority shared their frustrations on the exclusion of the management of the farm.

(i) **Other challenges and shortcomings at Mangetti Farm**

- The calving percentage is 35% which is low – the calving percentage should be above 35%.
- Basic material and supplies including goods and equipment have to be ordered from Windhoek causing hardship and delays in the management of the farm.
- The farm management experience a shortage of suitable vehicles, as most vehicles are obsolete.
- There is no petty cash to purchase basic supplies for the farm.
- Under the new management, employees at the ranch now have to travel long distances to access basic necessities;
- Previously, there was a shop managed by the employees themselves, which provided easy access to essential food items without the need for extensive travel. Now, for just 10 kilograms of maize meal, workers need to find transportation to the nearest town, whether it be Grootfontein, Tsumeb, or the furthest, Rundu.

(ix) Strategic Plan

The strategic plan for Mangetti Farm will include the following:

(a) Leverage on the Meat Board of Namibia plan of electrification of commercial farmers;
(b) Dedicate section 1,2 and part of Mangetti West for production cows and the other parts of MW for bulls;
(c) Weaners and steers including culled cows can be in section 3,4 and 5 while maintaining external fences;
(d) Establish mini-abattoirs at MW;
(e) Auction pen to be established at MW loading bay;
(f) Feedlot to be established at portion of Section 1 of the farm;
(g) Cultivated pastures and fodder production to be established at section 4;

(h) Water infrastructure at the farm should be upgraded; and
(i) The sections on the farm should be decentralized to sub-business units.

9. MAIN FINDINGS OF THE COMMITTEE

At all meetings, farmers criticized the Veterinary Cordon Fence (VCF) Policy which they said it needed to be reviewed as it was designed to favour a minority group at the expense of the majority of Namibians.

The VCF is an age old policy dating back to the German colonial period that separates northern Namibia from central and southern parts of the country with the intention to control infectious disease among livestock

The rationale behind the policy has been that it has sustained the Namibian meat industry, particularly the export of such products to the European Union (EU) and other international markets. However, critics have been criticized the arrangement as limiting communal farmers access to lucrative domestic, regional and international markets.

It was revealed during some meetings that, Namibia has over 2.5 million cattle found in the NCAs while the southern part of the veterinary cordon fence accounts for 1.3 million cattle. The export of NCA cattle to international markets is however, restricted by the VCF, and referred to as the red line.

Poor and sometimes mismanagement; and inadequate maintenance of important GRN property and infrastructure, such as quarantine farms, camps and facilities, crush pens, auction pens and abattoirs are matters of grave concern to the Committee, having serious adverse consequences on livestock market accessibility in the NCAs.

Specific issues highlighted during the stakeholder's meetings and oversight visits include the following:

9.1. Profitability and Lack of access to lucrative livestock markets

Most farmers in the NCAs have lamented non-functional abattoirs, the poor state and limited capacity of livestock infrastructures in the area as the main reason they continue to struggle to gain access to a lucrative livestock market. The situation has resulted into most farmers in the NCAs opting to sell their livestock at low prices as compared to their counterparts in the SCAs, such as two thousand Namibian Dollars (N$ 2,000) per cattle compared to a significant higher amount in the SCAs. It was further stated that, the maintenance of quarantine facilities should be managed by farmers within their respective regions in order to avoid vandalism of such facilities.

9.2. Lack of feedlots for animals and support to small scale farmers

The issue of lack of feedlots and animal fodder production was brought to the attention of members whereby stakeholders emphasized on the need for the government to subsidize and support small scale farmers in terms of feedlots and fodder production.

Some of the green schemes such as Musese and Sikongo in Kavango region can be utilized by the GRN (Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform) to produce animal fodder and sell to farmers at low/affordable prices.

9.3. Pricing/Equalization Fund

Farmers were concerned about the price discrepancies charged by MEATCO to farmers within the Northern and Southern Communal Areas, despite the same quality of meat produced in those areas. They stressed that, farmers in the Southern Communal Areas are being paid high prices as compared to their counterparts in the NCAs for instance; N$ 60 p/kg in the SCAs as opposite to N$ 43 p/kg in the NCAs hence, the need to equalize the funds

However, an official from Meatco revealed during the meeting in Katima Mulilo that, the company has submitted submissions for the government to introduce an equalization fund to enable MEATCO to pay equal funds to farmers in both the Southern communal areas and their counterparts in the NCAs.

9.4. Limited grazing areas due to drought

Farmers complained about lack of grazing for their animals due to large tract of fenced land occupied by quarantine farms. This situation has forced farmers to graze their cattle in neighboring countries such as Angola. They appealed for the two governments (Namibia and Angola) to collaborate and vaccinate their cattle at the same time in order to combat diseases such as FMD and other animal diseases. Another proposal was to put the water canal alongside the border for the purpose of preventing FMD diseases.

9.5. Lack of operational and development budget for quarantine camps and abattoirs

It was noted during most of the meetings that there is no budget earmarked for the quarantine and abattoir facilities within the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform (Directorate Veterinary Services).

Such activities are being carried out under project funding of American and European Funds such as the Millennium Challenge Account and the EDF 11 fund respectively. As such, there is a need for the government to allocate specific operational and development budget allocations, through the Vote of MAWLR in order to cater for quarantine services.

9.6. Lack of training/awareness programs for farmers in livestock rearing and compliance standards on meat markets

It was revealed during some meetings that, farmers lack knowledge on livestock rearing and compliance standards on meat markets as such, the government should capacitate them (farmers) by providing training in this regard.

9.7. Infrastructural Challenges/Limitation of products

Members were informed that some meat products produced at abattoirs such as the offal cannot be sold outside such region for instance; for example, the ones produced at Katima Mulilo abattoir lack market within the region.

9.8. Delay in payment of farmers

The waiting period for farmers to receive their payment after selling their livestock to MEATCO takes too long and costly. This is due to Commodity Based Trade (CBT) which requires the quarantine of animals for 30 days and during such period, the livestock is under the farmer's name and not MEATCO. Therefore, such process was said to be too cumbersome and need to be shortened or reviewed.

9.9. Lack of grader to clear the grass within and outside quarantine facilities

There were quite a number of grass species within and outside the quarantine facilities that were visited due to the absence of graders to clear such grasses. During the oversight visit at Kopano Quarantine camp in Zambezi region, Members were informed that the DVS has procured a grader without considering the Operator and the diesel could only be obtained from NAMCOR in Otjiwarongo. As such, the grader is not being utilized due to the absence of an Operator.

9.10. Overgrazing within the quarantine facilities

When farmers take their livestock to be quarantined, animals are expected to be fattened but they tend to lose weight once they are quarantined due to overgrazing.

9.11. Drought Relief Incentives

The drought relief incentives provided to farmers by the Office of the Prime Minister during drought season takes long; approximately 6 months for farmers to be re-reimbursed hence, the need for such responsibility to be given to MEATCO.

9.12. Lack of Meat Processing Plants

Stakeholders cited the lack of meat processing plants in the NCAs to assist local abattoirs store and process animals into meat for consumption and to sell meat to local supermarkets, hence, the need to establish such facilities within the local NCAs.

9.13. Locality and Limited number of Loading Points coupled by high transport costs, bad roads and poor network

Most farmers complained about lack of loading points which are located at far distances. Farmers are equally challenged by lack of transport to transport their animals to such facilities due to limited number of disinfected trucks by Meatco and the loading of animals is mostly done by people with private trucks who charges high transport costs such as N$ 350-500 per head of cattle. Therefore, most Farmers tend to lose their animals through trolley system in the absence of disinfected trucks. Poor road infrastructures (bad roads) and poor network was cited to be some of the contributing factors hampering farmers in accessing livestock markets.

During the meeting in Rundu, Members were informed that five (5) trucks were expected to be procured under the European Fund (EDF 11) to assist farmers to take their livestock to quarantine facilities but the initiative never materialized.

9.14. High cattle ear tag prices

Farmers were concerned about the high ear tag prices which they pay when selling their cattle to MEATCO, i.e. N$ 24 per cattle per ear tag - the price need to reviewed or reduced.

9.15. Vandalism, stock theft and lack of proper fencing at Quarantine and Abattoir Facilities

Most of the facilities visited by the Committee in the NCAs are said to be in dilapidated state due to lack of security guards to protect the premises.

Stock theft, including cross border stock theft is equally taking place due to poor and vandalized fences.

9.16. Staff shortage and Office Equipment at Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform (DVS) Regional Offices

Staff shortage and lack of equipment at the Regional Offices of the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform (DVS) are of equal concern.

According to the staff establishment at Kopano Quarantine camp, they are supposed to be eight personnel but only three Workhands are being employed. There is also an absence of a Quarantine Master at Kopano Quarantine Camp for the past 3 to 4 years. There is equally no veterinary clinic for Kavango East and West for the past five years and services are being offered under trees. There is equally lack of office equipment such as; computers and printers.

Furthermore, members noted with concern that, there are some casual workers who have been appointed by the MAWLR for more than twenty years without permanently being employed despite the existing vacancies in the establishment.

Due to staff shortage, quarantines and vaccines are being run concurrently resulting in scaling down of activities.

9.17. Drought and Fire outbreak at Quarantine and Abattoir facilities

Drought and Fire outbreak was cited as some of the challenges faced by farmers particularly, during dry season when low rainfall is being experienced. This results in fences being weak, requiring constant maintenance.

9.18. The 'porous' border between Namibia and Angola

The aforesaid border presents a risk for livestock as they end up mixing with animals that may not be vaccinated. The restrictions of animals from the Northern Communal Areas to the Southern Communal Areas makes farmers to graze their animals in the neighbouring Angola.

10. CONCLUSION

Based on the above findings by the Committee, it is quite evident that farmers in the Northern Communal Areas have no access to lucrative markets as compared to their counterparts, south of the VCF.

This is attributed by factors such as the Veterinary Cordon Fence Policy, which restricts livestock producers, north of the cordon fence to freely market their animals, south of the Cordon Fence due to Foot and Mouth Disease and Contagious Bovine Pleuropneumonia restrictions.

However, the Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform is steadfast that eradication of the FMD and animal diseases cannot be achieved with a porous border line between Namibia and its neighbouring countries mainly Angola, Zambia and Botswana, as it is difficult to prevent cross border movements of livestock.

In light of the above, the Ministry proposed that, the only way to get eradicate the contagious diseases in the NCA is to establish a physical border movement in order to curb introduction of FMD, CBPP as well as lung sickness and other animal diseases from the neighbouring countries.

Furthermore, quarantine camps, auction pens, crush pens, slaughter houses, abattoir facilities intended to assist farmers access their livestock in the NCAs are either non-functional, under-utilized or dilapidated, impacting negatively on market access.

Limitations to access markets is aggravated by the poor management and/or mismanagement; and poor maintenance or non-maintenance of important GRN property and agricultural infrastructure, meant to benefit communities, including the farming community.

11. RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the above findings, observations and inputs from the petitioner, Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform, Namibia National Farmers Union, farmers, officials and all stakeholders who attended the meetings, public hearings/consultations and onsite visits, the Committee now recommends to the National Assembly as follows:

11.1 The Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform and all relevant OMAS should formulate a policy framework and amend the current Act to allow the NCA farmers to have access for marketing their livestock south of the veterinary Cordon fence.

11.2 Non-functional and dilapidated quarantine and abattoir facilities in the NCAs

(a) The Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform (MAWLR) in collaboration with the National Planning Commission, Ministry of Works and Transport and Ministry of Finance and Public Enterprises must allocate funds in the 2024/25 FY, 2025/26 and 2026/27 Development Budget for the upgrading, development of new infrastructure and expansion of the existing infrastructure in all the regions of Northern Communal Arears such as: drilling of boreholes, upgrading and construction of quarantine farms and camps, abattoirs, slaughter-houses, auction pens and crush pens to cater for the entire NCAs. If no infrastructure exists, new infrastructure should be constructed.

(b) MAWLR should consider subsidizing the operations of abattoirs in order to help reduce overhead costs and enhance competitiveness.

(c) MAWLR must allocate specific/operational and development budget to cater for the quarantine and abattoir facilities and to assist DVS with the necessary equipment in order to enable them to operate effectively.

(d) MAWLR should fast-track the upgrading and renovation of quarantine and abattoir facilities for effective linkage to export approved abattoirs in the NCAs. New facilities should be constructed when there is none.

11.3 To address lack of feedlots and fodder production, MAWLR, Namibia Agronomic Board, Meatco, Meat Board of Namibia in collaboration with NNFU and other stakeholders to be identified by the Ministry should:

(a) Establish feedlots at Green Schemes in the proximity of GRN abattoirs as support to abattoirs to help improve offtake and quality as well as ensure constant supply of cattle to abattoirs;

(b) Subsidize farmers with fodder by way of establishing certain green schemes such as; Musese and Sikondo green schemes in Kavango West region and Uvhungu-

vungu and Ndonga Linena in Kavango East region to produce fodder and sell to farmers at low or affordable prices.

11.4 In order to address issues of dilapidated of quarantine facilities, prevent vandalism, stock theft and theft of quarantine assets:

(a) MAWLR should review the management and maintenance of GRN quarantine farms, facilities and abattoirs and consider the management of quarantine facilities jointly with local traditional authorities, local farmers' unions and employ permanent security guards to safeguard the facilities.

11.5 In order to address the issues of Lack of grader to clear the grass within and outside quarantine facilities: MAWLR should procure graders to clear the grass within and outside quarantine facilities with the view to combat theft and avoid fire outbreak, particularly, during dry seasons.

11.6 With regards to limited access to markets in the Zambezi region, MAWLR should negotiate with their Zambian counterparts and open borders for cattle selling.

11.7 MAWLR should consider constructing and setting up a water canal between Namibia and Angola in order to control the movement of cattle between the two countries, to prevent the spread of FMD and other animal diseases.

11.8 The Code of Good Practice of 2023 released in January 2023 as an instrument to assist abattoirs to breakeven of their throughput, compelling Government entities to first procure meat from government abattoirs before procuring from private entities, should be converted or turned into regulations and directives and be implemented as such, in order to compel all O/M/As to purchase meat from the local farmers within the NCAs.

11.9 In order to avoid price discrepancies for the payment done by MEATCO to farmers in the Northern Communal Areas as opposed to their counterparts in the Southern Communal Areas, MAWLR should introduce equalization funds to enable MEATCO to pay equal prices to both farmers.

11.10 MAWLR must expedite the completion of the Ongwediva Meat Processing Plant to ensure the functioning of the Eenhana and Outapi abattoirs as support to local NCAs abattoirs.

11.11 MAWLR should equally construct Meat Processing Plants in the NCAs to assist local abattoirs store and process animals into meat for consumption and to sell meat to local supermarkets.

11.12 MAWLR should construct the permanent /fixed abattoir in Kunene region; in the meantime, there is a need to come up with a mobile abattoir in that region.

11.13 The Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform should capacitate farmers by creating awareness programs and providing them with training on livestock rearing and compliance standards markets.

11.14 MAWLR should regularly collaborate with the NNFU.

11.15 Nkurenkuru and the Kavango West Region

(a) The Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform (MAWLR) in collaboration with the National Planning Commission, Ministry of Works and Transport and Ministry of Finance and Public Enterprises should allocate funds in the 2024/25 FY, 2025/26 and 2026/27 Development Budget for the upgrading, development of new infrastructure and expand the existing infrastructure such as: drilling of boreholes for all constituencies in the Kavango West region, upgrading and construction of quarantine camps, abattoirs, slaughter-houses, auction pens and crush pens infrastructure to cater for the entire Kavango West region. If no infrastructure exists, new infrastructure should be constructed;

(b) MAWLR must ensure that the procurement of vaccines is processed early to ensure that enough vaccines are available for the Kavango West Region and all other regions of the country;
(c) DVS in collaboration with NNFU should provide animal health care awareness to farmers;
(d) MAWLR should create fodder production and feedlot facilities and infrastructure in the Kavango West region and other regions of the country;
(e) MEFT and MAWLR must find workable solutions to wildlife-human conflict within Kavango West Region including relocating elephants to more endowed national parks;
(f) MAWLR must urgently find solutions to the shortage of agriculture officials in Kavango West region to provide services to farmers;
(g) MAWLR in collaboration with National Planning Commission and Ministry of Works and Transport must include the upgrading and construction of roads in the Kavango West Region for the use of agriculture officials and farmers. Due to poor road network, it is difficult to reach some parts of the region when we are conducting vaccination/tagging campaigns or attending to sick animals; and
(h) MAWLR must procure new vehicles to addresses the shortage of GRN vehicles in Kavango West Region.

11.16 Mangetti Farm – Kavango Cattle Ranch

(a) ***Mismanagement and Irregularities***

(i) Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade, Ministry of Finance and Public Enterprises and NIDA, in collaboration with the Office of the Prime Minister, Office of the Auditor-General, Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform, Ministry of Labour, Industrial Relations and Employment Creation and Ministry of Works and Transport must urgently set up a task-team or forensic inquiry. The task team should inquire, investigate and find solutions to the allegations of mismanagement and

irregularities including, inefficiency and ineffectiveness, loss of cattle and property through theft; damage to infrastructure, poor labour relations and low morale of employees at Mangetti Farm, Kavango Cattle Ranch. The report on the investigation should be tabled in the National Assembly.

(ii) Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade, Ministry of Finance and Public Enterprises, NIDA, MAWLR, Namibia Statistics Agency and Office of the Auditor-General must urgently conduct a herd count of all the cattle on the farm.

(b) ***Infrastructure and Quarantine Facilities***

Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade, Ministry of Finance and Public Enterprises, NIDA, in collaboration with MAWLR, National Planning Commission and Ministry of Works and Transport must allocate funds in the 2024/25 FY, 2025/26 and 2026/27 Development Budget. The budget should provide for the upgrading, development of new infrastructure and expand the existing infrastructure at Mangetti Farm such as: drilling of boreholes, upgrading and construction of quarantine camps, mini-abattoirs, slaughter-houses, auction pens and crush pens infrastructure to cater for the entire Kavango West region. If no infrastructure exists, new infrastructure should be constructed;

(c) ***Human-Wildlife Conflict – Elephants***

(i) MEFT in collaboration with Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade, NIDA, MAWLR, Namibian Defence Force and the Namibian Police must relocate the elephants to existing national parks;

MEFT must complete the rehabilitation of boreholes and construct elephant friendly drinking water points, particularly in section 5 of the farm; station officials at KCR must attend to and act upon the elephant challenges and threats; and allocate NIDA with a quota for elephant trophy hunting;

(ii) Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade, Ministry of Finance and Public Enterprises, NIDA, in collaboration with the MEFT and the Namibian Police Force must:

a. increase and strengthen the current security team to patrol the farm, regularly; and
b. install CCTV cameras at strategic points and procure drones for surveillance purposes; and
c. train employees on wildlife behaviour responses.

(d) ***Poor labour relations and low morale of employees***

NIDA in collaboration with the Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade and Ministry of Finance and Public Enterprises must guarantee employment of employees, initiate training and development programs for employees; and improve the labour relations on the farm.

(e) Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade, Ministry of Finance and Public Enterprises and NIDA must fast-track the full implementation of Mangetti Farm-KCR Strategy Plan.

(f) Ministry of Industrialsation and Trade and NIDA should consider decentralizing procurement function and the budget account for procurement.
(g) Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade, Ministry of Finance and Public Enterprises, NIDA, in collaboration with the MEFT, MAWLR and the Meat Board of Namibia must install cattle chip monitoring devices;
(h) Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade, Ministry of Finance and Public Enterprises and NIDA in collaboration with the Office of the Prime Minister (Cabinet) and the Ministry of Urban and Rural Development should consider the decentralisation of the management of NIDA in respect of the Mangetti Farm - Kavango Cattle Ranch to Kavango West Regional Council for proper administration, inclusiveness and transparency. The Uukwangali Traditional Authority should also form part of the decision making and management of Mangetti Farm – Kavango Cattle Ranch.

11.17 The Committee further recommends for an amendmend of the regulatory framework that guide the operations of the Veterinary Cordon Fence (VCD) to allow free movement of animals and animal products to markets during periods without active foot and mouth disease outbreaks, while still enforcing controlled measures to prevent any potential spread of the disease. Currently, mandatory quarantine procedures and the lack of adequate quarantine facilities place an undue burden on farmers, hindering their access to markets and impacting their livelihoods. Therefore, in non-outbreak times, cattle should be allowed to move freely provided that basic health certifications or recent veterinary checks are obtained, coupled with a robust traceability system and temporary health checkpoints along key routes to monitor for any signs of FMD as it is done on the South of the VCF. In addition, should an outbreak occur, strict quarantine measures can be promptly reinstated, and there should be continued investment in upgrading quarantine facilities to ensure a swift and effective response. This balanced approach supports the economic viability of the livestock sector while maintaining necessary public health safeguards.

12.Implementation of recommendations of Committees

In accordance with the Committee Rules of the National Assembly, when the Assembly accepts, with or without amendments, any recommendation of a Standing Committee on any subject, and the recommendation requires an Office, Ministry, Agency or Government Entity to perform or to refrain from performing an action, the Office, Ministry, Agency or Government Entity must comply with the recommendation of a Committee adopted by the Assembly, within a period of three (3) months or earlier.

SIGNATURES

Hon. Natangue Ithete (Chairperson)	Date 13/02/2025
Hon. Mathias Mbundu (Deputy Chairperson)	
Hon. Dr. Tobie Aupindi	
Hon. Apius! Auchab	
Hon. Yvette Araes	
Hon. Bertha Dinyando	
Hon. Elifas Dingara	
Hon. Reginald Diergaardt	
Hon. Maria Elago	
Hon. Hamunyera Hambyuka	
Hon. Maria Kamutali	
Hon. Sebastiaan Karupu	
Hon. Johanna Kandjimi	
Hon. Marina Kandumbu	
Hon. Gotthard Kasuto	
Hon. Dr. Daniel Kashikola	
Hon. Helaria Mukapuli	
Hon. Fennie Nanyeni	
Hon. Nico Smit	
Hon. Kennedy Shekupakela	
Hon. Jennifer Van Den Heever	